

Tribal India — Development, Forest Policies & FRA 2006

Complete Study Guide | UPSC Anthropology Optional

Paper 2 — Unit 6.3

Source: Sarrthi IAS L-62 (Nataraj Sir)

Handout 3

▼ CHAPTER OVERVIEW — Key Themes

Developmental Projects

Tribal Displacement

R&R Policy 2007

Forest Acts 1865–1988

Forest Rights Act 2006

CFR & Gram Sabha

Climate Change & TEK

Industrialization

Urbanization

Das & Banerji 4 Impacts

① Developmental Projects & Tribal Displacement

▼ MIND MAP — Developmental Projects

Michel Cernea — People-centric R&R

50 million displaced

Dam Projects (Narmada, Polavaram)

Mining Projects (Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh)

8.6% population → 40-50% displaced

R&R Policy 2007

Introduction

Development of infrastructure is necessary for national growth. However, projects on **forest lands** result in **displacement of tribals** living at construction sites, with a huge impact on their lives. Development and displacement have become uncomfortable companions in post-independence India.

Michel Cernea

- Involuntary displacement should be **minimised** and, if possible, **avoided**.
- If unavoidable, displacement must be carried out in a way that **protects the livelihood of tribes**.
- Rehabilitation and resettlement should be **"people-centric"** in approach.

Nalin Negi & Sujata Ganguly (2011, University of Bielefeld, Germany)

- Around **50 million people** displaced due to development projects in India.
- **40–50% of the displaced are tribals** — a severe disproportionate impact.
- Tribal population = only **8.6%** of total India — yet bear the majority of displacement burden.

Examples of Dam-Induced Displacement

DAM PROJECT | Andhra Pradesh

Case Study 1 — Polavaram Dam

Resulted in estimated displacement of **3 lakh people**, the majority of whom were tribals. A stark illustration of how dam projects disproportionately affect tribal communities.

DAM PROJECT | Narmada River

Case Study 2 — Sardar Sarovar Dam (Narmada Eviction)

- On **12 December 1979**, despite widespread protests, the Indian government decided to raise the height of the Sardar Sarovar Dam.
- Plan: **30 major, 135 medium, and 3,000 small dams** on the Narmada and its tributaries.
- Purpose: Provide water to 40 million people + irrigation + electricity generation.
- Impact: **200,000 people displaced**, majority Adivasis — one of India's largest displacement events.

Examples of Mining-Induced Displacement

MINING PROJECT | Jharkhand

Case Study 3 — Pakri Barwadih Coal Mining Project (Hazaribagh District)

- Operated by **NTPC (National Thermal Power Corporation)** under the **North Karanpura Coalfield**.
- Land acquisition began **2016**; involves **3,319.42 hectares** (8,202 acres) — including 1,950.5 ha farmland, 643.9 ha forest land, 101.22 ha settlements.
- **19 villages** affected — Barkagaon, Sonbarsa, Pakri Barwadih, Deoria Khurd.
- Compensation: Rs 9.85–10.85 lakh per adult; re-employed only as **contract guards or labourers** on land they once owned.
- Promised jobs for women ended when factories shut down.
- In Jharkhand overall, mining companies acquired **over 87,000 hectares** — larger than the city of Bengaluru.
- Skilled jobs went to migrants from other states; locals left unemployed.
- Jharkhand's **2008 Rehabilitation and Resettlement Policy** promised locals would benefit first — in reality, **tribals lost both land and livelihood**.

MINING PROJECT | Chhattisgarh

Case Study 4 — Chaal Coal Mine, Raigarh District (Kawar Tribe)

- **Chaal open-cast coal mine**, Raigarh district, operated by **South Eastern Coalfields Limited (SECL)** since **2003**.
- Displaced **~400 Adivasi (Kawar tribe)** families from **Lath village**, leaving only 56 families behind.
- Farmlands and rice fields destroyed by blasting and excavation → loss of livelihood + forced migration.
- Mine waste discharged into nearby rivers → **severe water contamination** (cut off clean water and fish supply).
- Promised jobs and compensation remained **only on paper**.
- **Hindalco Industries** nearby demolished Adivasi homes for mine expansion **without consent or compensation**.
- Together, these cases demonstrate **land alienation, livelihood loss, and erosion of tribal dignity and culture**.

Impacts of Displacement

Livelihood Impacts

- Loss of access to forest lands and forest produce.

Socio-Cultural Impacts

- Loss of **natural habitat** lived in for generations.
- Forced to move to fringes with no access to forest or forest produce.
- **Economic Impacts**
 - Loss of access to **Minor Forest Produce** (MFP).
 - Transformation into **landless peasants**.
 - Severe poverty among tribals.
 - Shift to industrial labour from traditional occupations.
 - Inadequate and delayed monetary compensation.
- **Reduction of collectiveness** to individualistic attitude — loss of community values.
- Agriculturalists forced into **industrial labour** — loss of traditional livelihoods.
- **Religious transformation** — ritualistic cultures fade.
- Changing marriage rules — shift from **endogamy to exogamy** due to displacement.

National Rehabilitation and Resettlement Policy, 2007

Key Objectives:

1. To **minimise displacement** and promote non-displacing or least-displacing alternatives.
2. To ensure **adequate rehabilitation package** with active participation of affected families.
3. To ensure special care for **protecting rights of weaker sections** — SCs and STs — with sensitivity.
4. To provide a **better standard of living** and sustainable income to affected families.
5. To **integrate rehabilitation** concerns into development planning and implementation process.
6. To facilitate harmonious relationships through **mutual cooperation**.

Key Conclusion: Displacement has always been a companion of development. The process should be as **humane and voluntary** as possible. Cost of rehabilitation should be included in project cost.

② Forest Policies — Colonial Era to Post-Independence

▼ MIND MAP — Forest Policy Evolution

1865 — Formal state control

1878 — Reserved/Protected/Village forests

1894 — Eminent Domain

1927 — IFA, Section 64

1952 — Concessions not rights

1980 — Protect tribal rights

1982 — Roy Burman Committee

1988 — PARADIGM SHIFT; JFM

2006 — FRA: Historical Justice

Tribal-Forest Relationship

Tripathi (2016)

- Tribes live in a *harmonious and interdependent relationship* with their forest environment.
- Their **economic life, social organisation, and magico-religious beliefs** all revolve around the forest ecosystem.
- Existence of tribal communities is **deeply linked with forests** — a true **symbiotic relationship**.

Forest Policy Timeline

Year	Act / Policy	Key Provision / Significance
1865	Forest Act	First formal state control over forests. Traditional practices restricted by law. Forests treated as state property.
1878	Forest Act	Divided forests into Reserved, Protected, and Village Forests . Trespassing, grazing, collecting produce — prohibited or declared offences. Consolidated Forest Department power.
1894	First Forest Policy	Introduced concept of " Eminent Domain " — state ultimate control over forest land. Stated: "Rights and privileges of individuals must be limited." Focused on revenue generation and timber supply for British needs.
1927	Indian Forest Act	Codified previous forest laws. Strengthened powers of forest officers. Section 64 — authorised arrest without warrant. Created to serve British timber needs; overrode customary rights; declaring forests as state property . Led to clearing of millions of hectares for monoculture plantations. Forces people to choose between abandoning forest or living as "criminals."
1952	National Forest Policy	Continued colonial approach. Tribals given <i>concessions</i> not <i>rights</i> . Emphasised forests as national asset — ignored livelihood dependence.
1980	National Committee on Development of Backward Areas	Recommended that tribal rights and concessions be fully protected , and domestic needs be met through forest produce. Recognised importance of forest-based livelihoods.
1982	B.K. Roy Burman Committee on Forests and Tribals	Headed by eminent anthropologist B.K. Roy Burman . Highlighted tribes earn nearly one-third of income from minor forest produce . Emphasised positive role of forest dwellers in forest preservation and regeneration. Suggested tribal participation for sustainable forest management.

Year	Act / Policy	Key Provision / Significance
1988	National Forest Policy — <i>PARADIGM SHIFT</i>	Shift from revenue-oriented to people-oriented forest management. Main objective: Environmental stability and ecological balance. Recognised sympiotic relationship between tribal people and forests. Introduced Joint Forest Management (JFM) . Recognised Minor Forest Produce (MFP) as a RIGHT , not a concession. Led to establishment of TRIFED . (Hiremath, 1994 — tribal communities should be actively involved.)
2006	Forest Rights Act (FRA)	Corrects historical injustice. Three types of rights: Land Rights, Use Rights, Community Forest Rights. Gram Sabha as central authority. Special provisions for PVTGs.
2007	National R&R Policy	Minimise displacement; adequate rehabilitation; protect rights of SCs/STs.
2019	Supreme Court Eviction Order	Ordered eviction of 1.8 million forest dwellers; later stayed due to activism and protests.

③ Forest Rights Act, 2006 (FRA) — In Full Detail

Exam Note: This is a standalone question topic. FRA 2006 can appear as a 10-mark or 20-mark question. Master every section below — objectives, provisions, issues, achievements, and way forward.

▼ MIND MAP — FRA 2006

Historical Justice

Land Rights (≤4 ha)

Use Rights (MFP, grazing)

CFR — Section 3(1)(i)

PVTG Habitat — Section 3(1)(e)

Cut-off date: 13 Dec 2005

14 Implementation Issues

Gram Sabha as authority

Mendha Lekha success

Hasdeo Arand violation

I. Objectives of FRA 2006

1. To undo the **historical injustice** suffered by forest-dwelling communities under colonial forest laws.
2. To ensure **land tenure, livelihood, and food security** of forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes (FDSTs) and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers (OTFDs).
3. To **strengthen conservation** — including responsibilities and authority for sustainable use, conservation of biodiversity, and maintenance of ecological balance.

II. Background — Why Was FRA Needed?

Conditions in Forest Areas (Pre-FRA):

- Millions of forest dwellers subject to **harassment and evictions** in their own land.
- **Torture, bonded labour, extortion, and sexual assault** quite common in forest areas.
- The **Indian Forest Act, 1927** declared forests as state property, overriding customary rights.
- Single officials settled disputes — mostly recording rights of **powerful communities**.
- Resulted in clearing of forests for monoculture; forced people to either abandon forests or live as "criminals."

III. Who is a Forest Dweller Under FRA?

Two-Stage Eligibility:

Stage 1 — Everyone must satisfy BOTH conditions:

1. Primarily residing in forests or forest lands.
2. Depends on forests and forest land for livelihood ("Bonafide livelihood needs").

Stage 2 — Must prove ONE of the following:

- Conditions have been true for **75 years** → classified as "**Other Traditional Forest Dweller**" (OTFD)
- OR — Member of Scheduled Tribe AND residing in a Scheduled Area → classified as "**Forest Dwelling Scheduled Tribe**" (FDST)

IV. Key Provisions Under FRA 2006 — Three Types of Rights

Type of Right	Provision	Key Details
A. Land Rights	Individual Forest Rights	• No rights to land not being cultivated prior to 13 December 2005. • Those cultivating without documents can claim up to 4 hectares, provided they cultivate it themselves for livelihood.
B. Use Rights	Collection & Grazing Rights	• Rights over collection of Minor Forest Produce (MFP) — tendu, herbs, medicinal plants (No timber). • Rights over grazing grounds and water bodies. • Traditional areas of use by nomadic or pastoralist communities.

Type of Right	Provision	Key Details
C. Community Forest Rights (CFR)	Section 3(1)(i)	• First time in Indian law: community has right to protect and manage the forest. • CFRs grant legal right to protect, regenerate, conserve, and manage forest resources. • In several states, Forest Department's control-oriented approach has slowed or obstructed CFR recognition.
D. PVTG Habitat Rights	Section 3(1)(e)	• Special provision for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups (PVTGs). • "Rights including community tenures of habitat and habitation." • Includes common habitat and habitats in reserved forests and protected forests.

V. Case Studies

POSITIVE CASE STUDY | Chhattisgarh & Odisha

Recognising CFR Rights — Kanger Ghati & Simlipal

- Chhattisgarh has recognised nearly **4,000 Community Forest Rights (CFRs)** — one of the most proactive states in India.
- **Kanger Ghati National Park** (Chhattisgarh) is the **second national park in India** (after Simlipal in Odisha) where CFR rights have been successfully recognised.
- In both parks, indigenous communities (e.g., **Gudiyapadar**) are allowed to reside within the park and create **community-led regulations** for sustainable forest use.
- This model illustrates a **balance between conservation and livelihood rights**.

Hasdeo Arand — Revocation of CFR Titles (Adani Mining)

- **Hasdeo Aranya region** — ongoing conflict between development projects and community rights.
- **Ghatbarra village** — one of the first villages to receive CFR titles (810 hectares in 2013).
- **District Level Committee revoked CFR rights in 2016** to facilitate mining in the **Parsa East Kete Basen (PEKB) coal block** (joint venture involving **Adani Enterprises**).
- **Hasdeo Aranya Bachao Sangharsh Samiti (HABSS)** challenged this in court — argued it violated Gram Sabha consent provisions and FRA's core principle.
- **Chhattisgarh High Court (October 2025)** upheld the revocation on technical grounds — disregarding evidence of Gram Sabha resolutions and community affidavits.
- Activists termed the judgment a "**mockery of the Forest Rights Act**" — warns of dangerous precedent allowing corporate interests to override legally recognised community rights.
- Underscores the **gap between law and implementation**.

VI. Implementation Issues of FRA 2006**ISSUE 1****High Rejection Rates**

Large number of claims rejected due to incomplete documentation, lack of proof of cultivation before 13 December 2005, or disputes between Forest and Revenue Departments. In **Odisha**, over **1.4 lakh claims were rejected**. Most states have not completed the review ordered by the **Supreme Court (2019)**. Genuine forest dwellers branded as *encroachers*.

ISSUE 2**Non-Communication of Rejections**

Rejected applicants rarely informed in writing, violating **Section 6(2)** of the Act — denying the **right to appeal within 60 days**. Irregular meetings of State Level Monitoring Committees add to procedural opacity.

ISSUE 3**Weak District Support**

Many district administrations fail to provide **revenue or forest maps** to Gram Sabhas, making verification difficult and creating a **gap between land claimed and land granted**.

ISSUE 4

Faulty Evictions

Thousands of families evicted from forest lands on incomplete or manipulated records. In **Hasdeo Arand (Chhattisgarh)**, the Ghatbarra village CFR title was cancelled to allow coal mining, violating due process.

ISSUE 5

Resistance by Forest Departments

Forest officials impede CFR recognition and retain control over forest management. **Section 3(1)(i)** of FRA — mandating community rights — is ignored in practice. *E.g.: In Tamil Nadu, Kattunayakans (honey collectors) face harassment from forest guards.*

ISSUE 6

Conflicting Laws and Policies

FRA's intent conflicts with **Forest Conservation Act (1980)**, **Wildlife Protection Act (1972)**, and **CAMPA (2016)**. The **2023 amendment** to FCA allows activities like **ecotourism and safaris** on forest land **without explicit Gram Sabha consent**.

ISSUE 7

Institutional Turf Wars

Poor coordination between **Ministry of Tribal Affairs (MoTA)** and **Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC)** — delays implementation and causes contradictory directions at state level.

ISSUE 8

Procedural Violations

Claims often rejected by **Forest Guards or Patwaris** who have **no legal authority** to do so. In places like **Chittorgarh**, rejections were made orally without notice, preventing any appeal.

ISSUE 9

Data Manipulation and Errors

In Chhattisgarh, reports by **ATREE** found duplicate entries and inflated data — only **243 Gram Sabhas** actually received community rights though records claimed 1,378.

ISSUE 10

Lack of Awareness

Many Gram Sabha members and OTFDs lack awareness about FRA provisions. Despite portals like **Adi Prashikshan**, awareness remains low in remote areas.

ISSUE 11

Judicial Uncertainty

The **2019 Supreme Court eviction order** created panic among **1.8 million forest dwellers**. Although stayed, most states are yet to review rejected claims properly.

ISSUE 12

Protected Area Displacement

Over **1 lakh forest dwellers** displaced from tiger reserves due to **NTCA relocations** without settling their FRA claims — a **conservation-vs-rights conflict**.

ISSUE 13

Mining and Clearance Violations

Forest clearances granted before FRA compliance. The **Hasdeo Arand case** (Adani-operated mine) showed cancellation of CFR titles without Gram Sabha consent — termed a **"mockery of FRA."**

ISSUE 14

Uneven State Progress

Only **Maharashtra (36%)**, **Chhattisgarh (24%)**, and **Odisha (10%)** have recognised substantial CFR rights. Other major states remain at near **zero recognition**.

VII. Significance and Achievements of FRA 2006

#	Achievement	Details
1	Historical Justice	Corrects "historical injustice" under colonial laws. Recognises both IFR and CFR/CFRR.
2	Comprehensive Rights	Sections 3(1)(b), 3(1)(c), and 3(1)(i) legally empower communities to access, occupy, and manage forest lands, water bodies, grazing areas, and biodiversity resources.
3	Empowered Gram Sabhas	FRA makes Gram Sabhas the central authority for claim verification and forest governance — promoting participatory democracy.

#	Achievement	Details
4	Community Stewardship Successes	Mendha Lekha (Maharashtra) and Betakata (Odisha) — formed CFR Management Committees (CFRMCs) that sustainably regulate forest use, prevent illegal felling, and conserve biodiversity.
5	Economic Empowerment	In Pajilibandha and Kalakani (Odisha) , women now earn ₹5,000–6,000 per month through Van Dhan Kendras — linking livelihoods with conservation.
6	Ecological Benefits	Soura Kurlanda — CFR village that restored degraded forests and increased biodiversity, showing community control enhances conservation.
7	Gender and PVTG Inclusion	Women and PVTGs participate in Van Suraksha Samitis , ensuring equitable access and decision-making power.
8	Link with PESA	States like Odisha and Maharashtra merged FRA implementation with PESA, giving legal corporate status to Gram Sabhas under Article 243G .
9	Technological Innovation	In Gujarat's Narmada district , NGOs used GPS and satellite imagery for digital maps in claim verification — now replicated in other states.
10	Administrative Achievement	As per MoTA (2024) , about 60% of total claims recognised, covering 13 million acres of land.
11	Global Model	When properly implemented, FRA balances livelihood security with biodiversity conservation — a global model of justice-based environmental management.

VIII. Way Forward and Suggestions

- 1. Review Rejected Claims** — States must review all rejected claims transparently, issue written reasons, ensure appeal rights under Section 6.
- 2. Strengthen Gram Sabhas** — Recognise as body corporates (as in Maharashtra and Odisha) for fund management and legal representation.
- 3. Joint Institutional Coordination** — Establish joint MoTA-MoEFCC mechanisms for consistent policy interpretation.
- 4. Digital Mapping Tools** — Adopt GPS and GIS mapping with BISAG and NRSC assistance to eliminate data duplication and manipulation.
- 5. Awareness and Training** — Expand Tribal Research Institutes and Adi Prashikshan-like platforms for grassroots legal training.
- 6. Livelihood Integration** — Link CFR areas with **TRIFED, Van Dhan Yojana, and PM-JANMAN** for forest-based income.
- 7. Legal Safeguards** — Mandate **Gram Sabha consent** before approving mining or diversion projects (prevent Hasdeo Arand-type violations).

8. Inclusive Participation — Encourage women, PVTGs, and marginal groups in decision-making and forest management.

9. Monitoring and Transparency — Create state-level dashboards with real-time data on claims filed, approved, and pending.

10. Model Replication — Scale up successful models from **Mendha Lekha and Betakata**; promote peer learning across states.

11. Policy Convergence — Integrate FRA with **Green India Mission, CAMPA, and National Biodiversity Strategy**.

12. National FRA Mission — Launch a dedicated National FRA Mission with a separate budget and time-bound targets for claim settlement.

IX. Supreme Court 2019 Order — Current Issue

SC Order (13 February 2019):

- Court ordered **eviction** of lakhs of STs and OTFDs across **16 states** whose claims had been rejected under FRA.
- Chief secretaries directed to carry out evictions by **July 24, 2019**.
- On **February 28, 2019**, court **stayed its order** — though it said "the mighty and the undeserving" who encroached would be shown no mercy.
- Stay was due to the **role of anthropologists and activists** raising awareness about real reasons for high rejection rates, and due to **tribal protests**.
- Court decided to examine whether **due processes were followed** by Gram Sabhas and states before rejecting claims.
- Most states are yet to complete the review properly.

X. Transition: Colonial Forest Control to Community-Based Governance

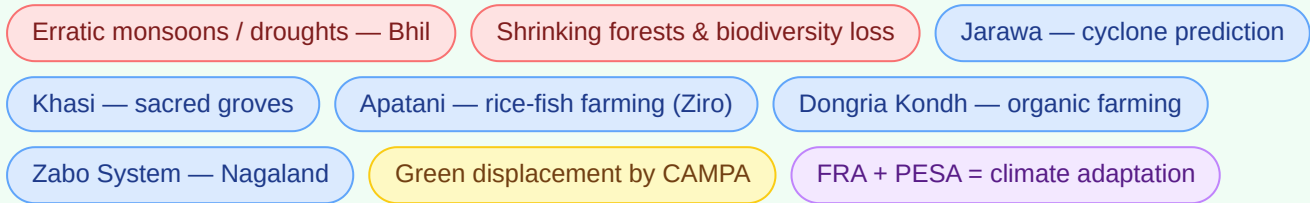
Dimension	Colonial / Early Post-Independence Era	Post-1988 / FRA 2006 Era
Control vs. Custodianship	Forest laws (1865–1927) aimed at state power and revenue extraction	Post-1988 and 2006 frameworks recognise tribal custodianship of forests
Bureaucratic vs. Community Governance	Top-down bureaucracy; forest department in complete control	FRA (2006) empowers Gram Sabhas as democratic forest managers
Exploitation vs. Ecological Justice	Extractive forestry — forests as commercial asset	Rights-based environmental justice ; conservation needs community participation

Dimension	Colonial / Early Post-Independence Era	Post-1988 / FRA 2006 Era
Economic Utility vs. Ecological Balance	Forests as economic resources for timber and revenue	1988 policy reframed forests as ecological assets — JFM and CFR
Persisting Contradictions	Old administrative mindsets persist. Conflicts between MoTA and MoEFCC continue to challenge implementation.	

Conclusion on Forest Policy: Forest policies in India reflect a journey from **colonial domination to democratic participation**. FRA (2006) embodies this transformation by recognising forest dwellers as **partners in conservation** rather than intruders. For its promise to be fulfilled, India must ensure effective implementation, community awareness, and strong Gram Sabha empowerment, so that **justice, sustainability, and livelihood security** truly reach those who live by the forest.

④ Climate Pressures on Forest-Dwelling Communities & Traditional Ecological Knowledge (TEK)

▼ MIND MAP — Climate Change & TEK



India's tribal and indigenous communities are among the **strongest protectors of forests and biodiversity**, yet they face the **severest impacts of climate change**. Their livelihoods, food systems, and cultural traditions are being reshaped by ecological disruption.

1. Risks and Problems Due to Climate Change

- Tribal livelihoods are highly **climate-sensitive** because they depend on forests, rainfall, and soil fertility.
- **Erratic monsoons and droughts** — threaten cultivation and forest produce. The **Bhil community in Gujarat**, once praying for rain, now faces destructive floods followed by prolonged dry spells.
 - **Shrinking forests and biodiversity loss** — reduce access to MFP such as tendu, mahua, and bamboo — undermining income and food security.
 - **Soil erosion and deforestation** — worsen migration, especially in Central India, while extreme heat and forest fires endanger crops and health.

2. Coping Through Tribal Ecological Knowledge (TEK)

Tribal Group	Location	TEK Practice
Jarawa	Andaman Islands	Predict cyclones by observing fish movement and sea behaviour — enabling timely evacuation
Khasi	Meghalaya	Community agroforestry and maintenance of <i>sacred groves</i> — preserving soil moisture and biodiversity in high-rainfall zones
Apatani	Arunachal Pradesh (Ziro Valley)	Rice-fish integrated farming — conserving water and enhancing soil fertility without chemicals. A UNESCO recognised system.
Dongria Kondh	Odisha	Organic multi-crop farming with traditional pest control and seed-saving — ensuring food and ecological security
Irular	Tamil Nadu	Organic multi-crop farming with traditional pest control and seed-saving practices
Zabo System	Nagaland	Combines rainwater harvesting, forestry, animal husbandry, and agriculture — maintaining fertility and reducing drought stress

3. Continuing Struggles and Policy Disconnect

- National programmes like **CAMPA** and the **Green India Mission** are largely top-down and have led to "**green displacement**" through afforestation without community consent.
- **Gender inequalities** are widening — tribal women bear the burden of resource collection and loss of autonomy.
- Traditional rain forecasting and shifting cultivation cycles are failing as climate shifts become unpredictable — eroding both livelihoods and ancestral knowledge.
- **Institutional fragmentation** between MoTA and MoEFCC and the neglect of Gram Sabha consent under FRA weaken adaptation from below.

4. Path Ahead: Integrating Rights and Resilience

- Integrate **FRA (2006)** and **PESA (1996)** into climate-adaptation frameworks and link them with schemes like **PM JANMAN**.
- Empower **Gram Sabhas** to manage eco-restoration and climate funds locally.
- Document and scale up models such as **Zabo and Apatani systems** across eco-regions.
- Strengthen the role of **tribal women and PVTGs** in decision-making and climate planning.
- Blend **community forecasting techniques** with modern satellite-based early-warning systems for better preparedness.

Key Insight: The people who nurture and protect India's natural ecosystems are the ones most endangered by climate change. Their survival depends not only on external support but on recognising them as **equal partners in climate adaptation and forest governance**.

⑤ Industrialization and Urbanization — Impacts on Tribal Communities

▼ MIND MAP — Industrialization & Urbanization

Das & Banerji (1964) — 4 Impacts

Social: Family breakdown, land loss

Economic: Unemployment, wage labour

Religious: Ritual decline

Psychological: Powerlessness

POSITIVE: Education, art, reform

Keonjhar — resource rich but poor

MP — India's largest tribal population

Gond paintings, Warli art

Introduction

- Tribal lands are not only rich in forest resources but also contain **rich mineral deposits**.
- Post-independence government exploited minerals for raw materials and constructed many projects in tribal lands.
- This development was supposed to uplift tribals — but instead **uprooted tribals from their dwellings**.
- They were deprived of land and paid meager cash which they used up eventually — leaving them **landless and moneyless**.
- Rules provide for **90% reservation for locals in employment** — but reality has been exactly the opposite.

Case Study: Madhya Pradesh — Encroachment and Forest Loss

CASE STUDY | Madhya Pradesh

India's Largest Tribal Population — and India's Highest Forest Encroachment

- MP has **India's largest tribal population — about 15%** of its total.
- Two belts: **Western — Bhil tribes (49%); Eastern — Gonds (36%)**.
- MP leads the country in **forest land encroachment** — over **5,347 square kilometres** lost, the highest in India.
- MoEFCC data: **MP alone lost 219.7 hectares of forest land** to infrastructure — about **24% of India's total forest diversion** over the last decade.
- **Dhyan Singh Case (2022, Shahdol district)**: Tribal man committed suicide after forest department demolished his hut built on **0.010 hectares** — barely a few meters of forest land. He had already received money under **Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana (PMAY)** to build the house. Department justified action under **Section 36(1) of Indian Forest Act, 1927**.

CASE STUDY | Odisha

Keonjhar — Resource Rich but People Poor

- Keonjhar district of Odisha — one of India's richest in iron ore and manganese, yet:
- Over **13 lakh children are stunted or underweight**.
- **74.7% of pregnant women are anaemic** (NFHS-5).
- **25.9% of women have a low BMI** (NFHS-5).
- Economic development primarily benefits corporations and outsiders, while tribal inhabitants remain impoverished.

Impacts of Industrialization and Urbanization

According to **Das and Banerji (1964)**, the impact can be studied under four major dimensions:

1. Social Impacts

a) Loss of Home and Forests

- Forests represent both **livelihood and identity** for tribal communities — food, fuel, medicinal plants, shelter, cultural and spiritual significance.
- Expansion of mining, dam, and industrial projects → forests rapidly depleted.

b) Breakdown of Family and Kinship

- **Das and Banerji (1964)** — industrialization and migration have weakened interpersonal ties within tribal families.
- Earlier, **joint family system** was the norm — ensuring collective ownership and strong kinship.

- Disappearance of forests deprives tribals of **economic base and sacred landscapes**.
- Destruction of sacred groves and ecological systems **weakens traditional beliefs and community bonds**.
- Result: large-scale displacement, land alienation, and loss of cultural stability.
- Migration → fragmentation into **nuclear units** → weakened traditional authority structures.
- Elders no longer hold decision-making power; younger generation adopts **individualistic values**.
- Rise in **divorces, inter-community marriages**, and decline in community-level festivals and rituals.
- Result: **erosion of kinship solidarity** and weakening of community cohesion.

2. Economic Impacts

a) Shift in Occupation

- Before industrialization: **subsistence agriculture, hunting, fishing, and forest collection** — family as basic unit of production.
- Industrialization introduced **individual wage labour** in factories, mines, and construction sites.
- Factory employment: **rigid hours, repetitive tasks, and impersonal relations** — contrasting with flexible communal nature of traditional tribal work.
- **Das and Banerji**: labour has shifted from a *collective social activity* to an *individual economic necessity*.

b) Unemployment and Casual Labour

- Majority of skilled/semi-skilled positions occupied by **non-tribal workers**; tribals employed temporarily as **unskilled labourers**.
- After project completion, jobs vanish → families left without income or land.
- Migration to urban centres → tribals end up as **construction workers, street vendors, or domestic helpers**, living in poor settlements without sanitation or healthcare.
- Shift from self-sufficient agrarian lifestyle to **economic dependency and urban poverty**.

3. Religious Impacts

- Industrialization and urbanization have led to gradual **decline in tribal religious and ritual life**.
- Rituals connected to agriculture, harvest, and forest worship are now **shortened or discontinued**.
- According to **Das and Banerji (1964)**, simplification of traditional ceremonies occurred largely due to **financial hardship** and **lack of leisure** in urban/industrial settings.
- Community shrines and sacred groves are often **inaccessible after displacement**.
- Absence of ritual spaces and collective participation → **breakdown of communal and spiritual identity** among displaced tribals.

4. Psychological Impacts

- Psychological consequences are **severe and long-lasting**.
- Displacement, loss of land, and cultural alienation create a deep sense of **insecurity and helplessness**.
- Individuals once living as independent cultivators or forest gatherers are now **dependent on employers or contractors**.
- Loss of control over their own lives often leads to **low self-esteem, frustration, and anxiety**.
- **Das and Banerji**: described this as the emergence of a sense of "**powerlessness**" among tribal populations.
- Younger generation — disconnected from traditional culture — faces **identity crises** and higher vulnerability to **substance abuse**.

5. Positive Impacts

Despite numerous adverse effects, some positive outcomes have emerged:

- Industrialization indirectly facilitated the spread of **education, healthcare, and infrastructure** in several tribal regions.
- Exposure to new ideas led to gradual **social reform** — declining acceptance of practices like **witch-hunting, child marriage, and gender-based taboos**.
- Traditional art and craft forms gained national and international recognition:
 - **Gond paintings** from Madhya Pradesh
 - **Warli art** from Maharashtra
 - Both promoted through cultural organisations and cooperatives.
- Several **NGOs and self-help groups** assist tribal communities in marketing **handicrafts, forest produce, and traditional goods** — enabling economic empowerment and cultural preservation.

Conclusion on Industrialization and Urbanization:

Industrialization and urbanization have brought **both development and destruction** to India's tribal societies. These processes expanded infrastructure and created new economic opportunities, but also displaced millions, dismantled traditional social systems, and eroded cultural values. The need of the hour is **inclusive and participatory development** — where tribal communities are treated as **partners rather than victims**. Sustainable development must integrate **economic growth with cultural preservation** and guarantee that the rights and welfare of tribal populations are not compromised in the pursuit of modernisation.

⑥ Key Scholars — Quick Reference

Scholar	Year / Context	Key Argument / Contribution
Michel Cernea	General theory on displacement	Involuntary displacement should be minimised, avoided if possible; if unavoidable — rehabilitation should be "people-centric."
Nalin Negi & Sujata Ganguly	2011, University of Bielefeld, Germany	~ 50 million people displaced by development projects in India; 40–50% are tribals.
Tripathi	2016	Tribes live in a <i>harmonious and interdependent relationship</i> with their forest environment; their economic, social, and magico-religious life revolves around forests.
B.K. Roy Burman	1982 Committee on Forests and Tribals	Tribes earn nearly one-third of their income from minor forest produce ; emphasised positive role of forest dwellers in preservation and regeneration.
Hiremath	1994	Tribal communities should be actively involved in forest protection, regeneration, and development.
Das and Banerji	1964	Impact of industrialization and urbanization on tribals studied under four dimensions: social, economic, religious, and psychological. Described emergence of "powerlessness" among tribal populations.

⑦ Key Government Policies, Acts, and Bodies

Policy / Act / Body	Year	Key Feature
Forest Act	1865	First formal state control over forests
Forest Act	1878	Reserved / Protected / Village Forest classification
First Forest Policy	1894	"Eminent Domain" — state ultimate control; timber for British needs
Indian Forest Act	1927	Codified forest laws; Section 64 — arrest without warrant; monoculture; people as "criminals"
National Forest Policy	1952	Concessions not rights; forests as national asset
National Committee on Backward Areas	1980	Recommended full protection of tribal rights and concessions
B.K. Roy Burman Committee	1982	Forest-tribal integration; one-third income from MFP
TRIFED	1987	Tribal Cooperative Marketing Development Federation — markets MFP, eliminates middlemen

Policy / Act / Body	Year	Key Feature
National Forest Policy	1988	Paradigm shift — people-oriented; JFM; MFP as right (not concession)
PESA	1996	Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas — tribal self-governance
Forest Rights Act (FRA)	2006	Three types of rights (land, use, CFR); Gram Sabha central authority; corrects historical injustice; cut-off date 13 Dec 2005; up to 4 hectares
National R&R Policy	2007	Minimise displacement; adequate rehabilitation; rights of SCs/STs protected
SC Eviction Order	2019	Ordered eviction of 1.8 million forest dwellers; stayed due to activism and tribal protests

⑧ Schemes Related to Tribal Welfare

Scheme	Purpose / Key Point
TRIFED	Market forest produce, eliminate middlemen; established 1987 under NFP 1988
Van Dhan Yojana / Van Dhan Kendras	Income generation through processing of forest produce. Women in Odisha (Pajilibandha, Kalakani) earning ₹5,000–6,000/month
PM-JANMAN	Holistic development programme for PVTGs (Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups)
Adi Prashikshan	Awareness portal for FRA provisions; legal and procedural training for FRCs and community leaders
CAMPA	Compensatory Afforestation — but criticised for causing "green displacement" through afforestation without community consent
Green India Mission	Afforestation programme — largely top-down, sometimes without community consent
Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana (PMAY)	Housing for tribals — but ironically used against tribal Dhyani Singh in MP (Shahdol case, 2022)
Joint Forest Management (JFM)	Partnership between Forest Department and local communities; introduced under NFP 1988

⑨ UPSC Probable Questions

Q1 | 20 Marks — Standard Question

"Discuss the impact of developmental projects on tribal displacement in India. What measures have been taken for rehabilitation of displaced tribals?"

Key: Michel Cernea, Nalin Negi & Ganguly (50 million, 40-50% tribals), Polavaram, Sardar Sarovar, Pakri Barwadih, Chaal Mine, R&R Policy 2007

Q2 | 20 Marks

"Examine the evolution of forest policies in India from colonial times to the present. How has the relationship between the state, forests, and tribal communities changed?"

Key: 1865 → 1878 → 1894 → 1927 → 1952 → 1980 → 1982 → 1988 (paradigm shift) → FRA 2006. Transition table.

Q3 | 10 or 20 Marks — Very Frequently Asked

"Critically evaluate the Forest Rights Act, 2006 — its objectives, achievements, and implementation challenges."

Key: Three types of rights, Gram Sabha, 14 implementation issues, achievements (Mendha Lekha, Betakata, 60% claims recognised), Way Forward

Q4 | 10 Marks

"Write a note on the role of Community Forest Rights (CFR) under FRA 2006 with case studies."

Key: Section 3(1)(i), Kanger Ghati, Simlipal, Mendha Lekha, Hasdeo Arand, Gram Sabha as forest manager

Q5 | 20 Marks

"Examine the impact of industrialization and urbanization on tribal communities in India with reference to Das and Banerji (1964)."

Key: 4 dimensions (social, economic, religious, psychological), Keonjhar, MP statistics, "powerlessness," positive impacts (Gond, Warli art)

Q6 | 10 or 20 Marks

"Discuss the significance of Traditional Ecological Knowledge (TEK) of tribal communities in the context of climate change adaptation."

Key: Jarawa (cyclone prediction), Khasi (sacred groves), Apatani (Ziro rice-fish), Dongria Kondh, Zabo system, Bhil (erratic monsoons)

Q7 | 10 Marks

"How has the 1988 National Forest Policy marked a paradigm shift in forest governance in India?"

Key: Revenue-oriented → People-oriented; JFM; MFP as right; Hiremath (1994); TRIFED; ecological balance as main objective

Q8 | 10 Marks

"Critically examine the 2019 Supreme Court eviction order and its implications for forest-dwelling communities."

Key: 13 Feb 2019, 16 states, 1.8 million forest dwellers, stay on 28 Feb, role of anthropologists/activists, due process issue

Q9 | 10 or 20 Marks

"Discuss the conflict between conservation and tribal livelihood rights with reference to the Hasdeo Arand case."

Key: Ghatbarra village, CFR titles 2013, revocation 2016, PEKB coal block, Adani, HABSS, HC 2025, "mockery of FRA"

Q10 | 10 Marks

"What is Joint Forest Management (JFM)? Discuss its significance for tribal communities."

Key: NFP 1988, partnership between Forest Department and local communities, led to TRIFED, recognition of MFP as right, empowerment through participation

⑩ Key One-Liners & Facts for Exam

Michel Cernea: displacement should be minimised, avoided, and rehabilitation should be **"people-centric."**

Tribal population = **8.6%** of India but constitute **40–50%** of all displaced persons.

Nalin Negi & Ganguly (2011): **50 million** displaced by development projects in India.

Tripathi (2016): tribes live in a *harmonious and interdependent relationship* with forests.

FRA 2006 recognises **three types of rights**: land rights, use rights, and community forest rights.

Cut-off date under FRA for land rights: **13 December 2005**.

Land ceiling under FRA: **up to 4 hectares** for those cultivating without documents.

PVTG special provision: **Section 3(1)(e)** of FRA — habitat rights.

CFR falls under **Section 3(1)(i)** of FRA.

B.K. Roy Burman (1982): tribes earn **one-third income** from minor forest produce.

1988 Forest Policy = **paradigm shift**; introduced JFM; MFP as right not concession.

TRIFED markets Minor Forest Produce; **Van Dhan Kendras** empower tribal women.

Das and Banerji (1964): four dimensions of impact — **social, economic, religious, psychological**.

Keonjhar (Odisha) — rich in iron ore/manganese but **74.7% of pregnant women are anaemic**.

Mendha Lekha (Maharashtra) and Betakata (Odisha) — **successful CFR community management models**.

Hasdeo Arand: CFR title cancelled for coal mining (Adani) — **"mockery of FRA."**

2019 SC order: eviction of **1.8 million forest dwellers**; stayed due to anthropologist/activist intervention.

MoTA (2024): **60% of total FRA claims recognised**, covering **13 million acres**.

MP has **India's largest tribal population (15%)**; leads in forest land encroachment (**5,347 sq km** lost).

Gond paintings (MP) and **Warli art (Maharashtra)** — tribal art gaining global recognition.

Indian Forest Act 1927, **Section 64**: authorised arrest without warrant for forest violations.

Pakri Barwadih: NTPC acquired **87,000+ hectares** in Jharkhand — larger than Bengaluru city.

Chaal Coal Mine, Chhattisgarh: displaced **400 Kavar tribe** families from Lath village.

Sardar Sarovar Dam: **200,000 people displaced**, majority Adivasis.

Chhattisgarh: recognised nearly **4,000 CFRs** — most proactive state in India.

Apatani (Arunachal Pradesh): **rice-fish integrated farming** in Ziro Valley — conserves water, enhances soil fertility.

Jarawa (Andaman Islands): predict **cyclones** by observing fish movement and sea behaviour.

Zabo System (Nagaland): combines rainwater harvesting, forestry, animal husbandry, and agriculture.

CAMPA and Green India Mission criticised for **"green displacement"** — afforestation without community consent.

Das and Banerji: emergence of sense of **"powerlessness"** among tribal populations due to industrialization.